

PXM ROI Calculator User Guide

A practical, first-time-user guide to preparing inputs, understanding every calculation, reading the results, and presenting a responsible customer business case.

Start here

Open the calculator at pxm-roi-calculator.vercel.app. Use this guide beside it during discovery, scoping, and value-review conversations.

What this guide covers	What the calculator produces
Creative production	Modeled cost, savings, and original HTML task logic
Content and asset operations	Hours returned and loaded-labor value
Growth and investment	Contribution, year-one ROI, payback, and 3-year value
Evidence and governance	How to label assumptions and avoid overclaiming

Important: this is a directional planning model, not a guarantee of results. Customer inputs and supporting evidence should be validated before the result is used in a final business case.

Use the calculator in six steps

The best experience begins with hard operational inputs, then adds growth assumptions only after the baseline case is credible.

Step	Action	Why it matters
1	Choose Conservative, Expected, or Upside.	Sets the realization factor applied to modeled benefits.
2	Enter the brand's current annual creative spend.	Creates the baseline for creative-production savings.
3	Describe a typical creative project.	Drives the exact overhead calculation inherited from the supplied HTML.
4	Enter content and asset workflow volumes.	Translates repetitive work into annual hours and labor value.
5	Add growth and PXM investment inputs.	Calculates contribution, net value, ROI, and payback.
6	Open Show calculation logic.	Audits the formulas using the current values on screen.

Recommended meeting sequence

Start with operational value. Set expected revenue lift to 0% and establish the case from creative spend, content operations, and asset operations. Then introduce growth contribution as a separately attributable upside.

Do not skip the baseline

Record the brand's source, owner, time period, and confidence level for every input. Without a baseline, future ROI remains an estimate.

What the calculator does not do

It does	It does not
Build a directional financial model	Guarantee conversion or revenue improvement
Use exact supplied creative task math	Validate the underlying internal role rates
Separate levers into a benefit breakdown	Replace finance, legal, or customer approval
Apply scenario realization factors	Prove that aggregate PXM usage caused a customer's ROI

Collect evidence before entering numbers

Use the strongest available source for each field. Customer-system data is preferable to interviews; interviews are preferable to generic assumptions.

Input group	Ask the brand	Preferred source
Creative	Annual spend, ASINs/project, concepts/project, projects/year	Budget, agency invoices, creative operations
Content operations	Products, updates/year, minutes/update, time reduction	PIM exports, time study, workflow interviews
Asset operations	Requests/year, minutes saved/request	Ticketing, email volume, DAM analytics, time study
Labor	Fully loaded hourly rate	Finance or HR; include benefits and overhead if approved
Growth	Revenue in scope, lift, margin, attribution	Commerce analytics and finance
Investment	Annual subscription and one-time implementation	Final commercial proposal

Confidence labels

Label	Use when	Presentation language
Customer actual	Directly exported or finance-approved	Measured
Customer estimate	Provided by a process owner	Customer-estimated
Pattern benchmark	Supported by a documented sample and method	Benchmark
Case-study report	Presented in approved sales collateral	Reported
Illustrative assumption	Used only to demonstrate the model	Illustrative - replace before approval

Current evidence note

The 2,080-hour, \$650K Skullcandy, and 'hours to minutes' statements come from the PXM Master Slide Library. The provided slides do not contain the underlying calculation workbooks, so the calculator labels them as reported or estimated outcomes.

Scenario factors

Scenario	Factor	Use
Conservative	70%	Budget review, limited adoption, or uncertain assumptions
Expected	100%	Most likely case using agreed inputs
Upside	130%	Expansion or high-adoption opportunity; never present alone

How the original HTML calculation works

This section replaces invented per-image assumptions with the exact task, rate, and scaling engine from Creative_Team_Overhead_Calculator_Client.html.

Field	Meaning
Current annual creative spend	Brand-provided baseline. It starts at zero and is not supplied by Pattern.
ASIN count/project	Number of Amazon product identifiers handled in one modeled project.
Concept count/project	Number of creative concepts. Concept tasks scale by this value.
AI images/ASIN	AI-generated images per ASIN. The original calculator defaults to 15.
Projects/year	Annualizes the modeled cost.
Seller type	Selects the original 1P or 3P role-rate table.
Delivery tier	Creative only uses 1.0x. + PM multiplies modeled cost by 1.2x.

Scaling rules

Rule	Calculation	Examples
Fixed	Task minutes x role rate	Onboarding, audits, Brand Story, Brand Store
Concept	Concept count x task minutes x role rate	Strategy, concept copy, concept design, prep
ASIN	ASIN count x unit factor x task minutes x role rate	Image stacks, A+ production, uploads

Key image formulas

AI ImageGen

ASINs x AI images/ASIN x 1 minute x \$0.14/minute x tier multiplier

Image stacks

ASINs x 9 units x original copy/design/QA/review task-rate mix x tier multiplier

A+ production

ASINs x 7 units x original copy/design/QA/review task-rate mix x tier multiplier

Understand the roll-up before discussing ROI

The modeled project includes more than AI image generation. It also includes onboarding, audits, concepts, production, uploads, Brand Story, and Brand Store.

Complete project cost

Sum the original task costs across Onboarding, Audits, Image Stacks, A+ Content, Brand Story, Brand Store, and AI ImageGen. Apply 1.2x only when the + PM delivery tier is selected.

Project cost	<code>sum(all task minutes x task scaling x role rate) x tier multiplier</code>
Annual modeled cost	<code>modeled project cost x projects per year</code>
Creative savings	<code>max(0, current annual creative spend - annual modeled cost) x scenario factor</code>

What appears on screen

Output	Interpretation
Modeled cost/project	The original HTML overhead calculation for the current project inputs.
Modeled time/project	Total task minutes divided by 60. PM changes cost but not modeled task time.
Modeled annual cost	Project cost multiplied by projects/year.
Creative-production benefit	Only positive savings versus customer-entered current spend.

Avoid a common mistake	Do not describe the full project cost as the cost of AI images. AI ImageGen is one phase inside a broader creative-delivery model. Open Show calculation logic to isolate the AI, image-stack, A+, project, annual, and savings figures.
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About the original rates

The HTML stores rates per minute: Art Director \$0.93 (1P) or \$0.87 (3P), Designer \$0.14, Copywriter \$0.12, QA \$0.10, and Asset Manager \$0.10. The guide documents the supplied model; it does not independently validate whether those rates should be shown externally.

Translate repetitive work into annual labor value

These formulas are ROI-model assumptions created for this calculator. They were not present in the supplied creative overhead HTML.

Field	Meaning	How to validate
Products in scope	Products affected by PXM	Catalog or implementation scope
Updates/product/year	Average annual update frequency	Sample change logs
Minutes/manual update	Current hands-on time per product update	Time study
Workflow time reduction	Share of manual effort removed	Pilot or conservative estimate
Asset requests/year	Search, resize, or share requests	Tickets, email, DAM usage
Minutes saved/request	Expected time reduction	Before/after time study
Loaded hourly rate	Labor cost including approved overhead	Finance/HR

Formulas

Content hours $\text{products} \times \text{updates/year} \times \text{minutes/update} \times \text{time reduction} \times \text{scenario factor} / 60$

Content value $\text{content hours} \times \text{loaded hourly rate}$

Asset value $\text{asset requests/year} \times \text{minutes saved/request} \times \text{scenario factor} / 60 \times \text{loaded hourly rate}$

Interpretation rules

Hours returned are not automatically headcount reduction. Describe the value as capacity returned, avoided future hiring, faster throughput, or redeployment to higher-value work unless finance has approved a direct cost reduction.

Avoid overlap. If a creative-spend baseline already includes the same internal labor counted in content or asset operations, separate the teams or remove the duplicate benefit.

Keep commercial upside separate from hard savings

The growth calculation converts an attributed revenue lift into contribution using gross margin. It should usually be introduced after operational value is established.

Field	Meaning	Caution
Annual revenue in scope	Revenue from products/channels influenced by PXM	Do not use total company revenue by default
Expected revenue lift	Relative improvement attributed to better content	Use a test, benchmark, or conservative estimate
Gross margin	Contribution retained after direct product cost	Use finance-approved margin
PXM attribution	Share of modeled lift credited to PXM	Controls over-attribution
Annual PXM investment	Recurring subscription and approved recurring cost	Use final proposal
One-time implementation	Migration, onboarding, and launch cost	Include known internal/external costs

Growth contribution

revenue in scope x revenue lift x gross margin x PXM attribution x scenario factor

Why attribution matters

Conversion and revenue change for many reasons, including price, media, assortment, availability, seasonality, and promotions. PXM attribution limits the share credited to content and workflow improvements.

A defensible progression

Level	Recommended treatment
Hard-savings case	Set revenue lift to 0%. Use only agreed creative and operating savings.
Expected case	Add a conservative lift and partial attribution supported by evidence.
Upside case	Show separately; never substitute it for the hard-savings case.

Turn the outputs into an executive business case

The right-hand panel summarizes value, timing, and the source of benefit. Read the outputs together, not in isolation.

Output	Formula	What to say
Gross annual benefit	Creative + content + asset + growth	Total modeled annual value before PXM cost
Year-one investment	Annual PXM + implementation	Cash investment included in year one
Year-one net value	Gross benefit - year-one investment	Value remaining after year-one cost
Year-one ROI	Net value / year-one investment	Return relative to year-one investment
Payback	Year-one investment / gross benefit x 12	Approximate months to recover the investment
3-year net value	3 x gross - 3 x annual PXM - implementation	Simple 3-year value without discounting or ramp
Hours returned	Content hours + asset hours	Operational capacity; creative project time is not counted as saved time

Annual benefit by lever

The stacked bar shows which levers create the result: Creative Production, Content Operations, Asset Operations, and Growth Contribution. A financially credible case should not depend entirely on a high growth assumption.

PXM scale signals

The W28 figures - 509K media stacks, 292K products with stacks, 819K syndicated products, and 33 active channels - are contextual platform proof points. They do not enter a brand's ROI math.

Reported customer outcomes

Statement	Approved interpretation
2,080+ hours	Estimated yearly hours reported for one customer through automation
\$650K Skullcandy	Estimated ROI reported in the Skullcandy case study
Hours to minutes	Reported reduction in asset-search time at 100 Percent

Run the meeting, then measure the result

The example below is illustrative. Replace every value with customer-approved inputs before presenting a final result.

Meeting moment	Presenter action
Discovery	Collect current creative spend, workflow volumes, rates, revenue scope, and investment.
First calculation	Use Conservative or Expected; set revenue lift to 0%.
Audit	Open Show calculation logic and walk through the image and labor formulas.
Upside	Add an evidenced growth assumption and partial PXM attribution.
Agreement	Record input owners, sources, confidence labels, and open questions.
Follow-up	Export or summarize the agreed scenario; do not circulate unvalidated defaults.

Recommended cadence

When	Purpose
Pre-sale	Directional business case using customer inputs
Kickoff	Lock the baseline and measurement owners
30/60/90 days	Track adoption and annualize early value carefully
Quarterly	Replace assumptions with actual workflow and usage data
Annually	Produce the customer-validated ROI and case-study candidate

Frequently asked questions

Question	Answer
Are the creative calculations exact?	They match the supplied HTML task engine. The validity of the underlying rates is a separate business question.
Are the other defaults Pattern benchmarks?	No. Treat unvalidated defaults as illustrative and replace them with brand inputs.
Why can creative savings be zero?	Savings never go below zero; current spend must exceed modeled annual cost.
Should growth be included?	Only with a defined revenue scope, margin, lift basis, and attribution factor.
Can this be called realized ROI?	Only after the customer baseline and post-launch actuals have been validated.

Final review question

Could a finance leader reproduce every important number from the documented source, formula, and time period? If not, label the result as directional and record the missing evidence.